dilemma. He thought that it was a great chance to get hold of him and negotiate for a bigger cause, while on the other hand, he was worried that the lack of men might push him to backfoot.

But as he arrived, the townsfolk appeared in unison making him run away for his life. Yet, Babur didn't deliberate to even think about any negotiations. He still was scared about the number of fighter men he had although the populace of town had proven to be his great ally.

Having seen him disperse away into the sands of Samarkand, Babur went to the citadel from the Iron Gate and dismounted at the Bustan Palace.

The happy faces, including those of men ranging from varying ranks and consequences to various headmen, came to get an audience with Babur. They blessed this young man of the Tīmūrid dynasty. Babur felt highly satisfied after having gained it once again. Samarkand had been the capital of the Tīmūrid dynasty for almost 140 years then.

Babur pondered joyfully upon his victory saying, 'An alien, and of what stamp! An Aūzbeg foe had taken possession of it! It had slipped from our hands; Allah gave it again! Plundered and ravaged, our own returned to us.' [*]

While Babur took Samarkand, Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā took Herat leaving the former surprised. Babur hadn't expected it to occur at all.

Babur observes in the *Baburnama* that there was a vast difference between him and Husayn's way of doing things. He did not see any similarity between the taking Samarkand and Husayn taking Herat. Babur has pronounced the differences as follows:[†]

Husayn Mīrzā

1. He had ruled many years, passed through many experiences and seen many affairs.
2. He had for the opponent, Yadgar Muhammad Nasir Mīrzā, an inexperienced eighteen-year-old boy.

   3.Head-equerry (Yadgar Mīrzā's), Mir Ali, a person well-acquainted with the particulars of the whole position, sent a man out from amongst Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā's opponents to invite him to surprise them.

4. His opponent was not in the fort but was in the ravens' garden. Moreover, Yadgar Muhammad Nasir Mīrzā and his followers are said to have been so